The Hot Stepper

Why your daily movement beats your 45-minute session.

Your session is 45 minutes out of 1,440. What you do with the other 23 hours is what decides your body composition.

WHAT YOUR STEPS ARE WORTH

STEPS A DAY	85KG	100KG	SAME ENERGY AS
5,000	~225 cal	~275 cal	20 min rowing · 20 min spin · 2.5km run
10,000	~450 cal	~525 cal	45 min rowing · 40 min spin · 5km run
15,000	~675 cal	~775 cal	65 min rowing · 60 min spin · 8km run

Calories burned walking at a steady pace. Rowing is moderate effort, spin a normal class pace. Real numbers vary by about 20%. The extra you burn above sitting is roughly a quarter lower, and that extra is what builds your deficit.

THE FAT-LOSS MATHS

- Aim for about 200-250 calories a day below maintenance. Steady and sustainable.
- Walking builds part of that deficit by itself. Going from 4,000 to 10,000 steps burns an extra 200-225 calories a day.
- Stack them. A small food deficit plus the step deficit puts you roughly 400-450 calories a day below maintenance.
- If the deficit is real, body fat comes down. Check your weekly average weight and your waist every 2-3 weeks. If nothing is moving, you need a bigger deficit.
- Watch the liquid calories. Two pints is 400+ calories, which wipes out a full day of extra steps.

FIVE TRUTHS ABOUT STEPS

01 It is not a magic number. 10,000 came from a 1960s Japanese pedometer ad, not a study.

02 7,000-8,000 steps does most of the work for your health. More steps keep burning extra energy for fat loss.

03 Walking is easy on appetite and recovery. Hard sessions leave you hungry and ready to eat it back. A walk rarely does.

04 Your weekly total counts. Big weekend walks add up. Keep a weekday base of about 5,000.

05 Do it in daylight. Morning or lunchtime light sets your body clock for better sleep tonight.

WHAT ELSE WALKING DOES

HEART
About 15% lower risk of early death for every extra 1,000 steps.

MIND
Less depression, anxiety and overthinking. More ideas when you walk.

BLOOD SUGAR
Ten minutes after a meal flattens the spike.

BACK
A walking programme nearly doubled the time before back pain returned.

SLEEP
Daylight and movement help you sleep better that night.

YOUR 4-WEEK PLAN

Week 1
Track your average. Change nothing.

Week 2
Add 1,000 steps a day.

Week 3
Add another 1,000, with a walk after dinner.

Week 4
Build toward 8,000-10,000. Long weekend walks encouraged.

EASY WINS

Walk your calls. · **Ten minutes after lunch and dinner.** · **Park further away.** · **Weekend walk with the family or a mate.**

HOW STRONG IS THE EVIDENCE?

Walking and lower risk of early death	STRONG	Eating below maintenance leads to fat loss	STRONG
Walking lowers depression and anxiety	STRONG	Walking lowers back pain returning	STRONG
Adding steps lowers body weight	MODERATE	Daylight walks improve sleep	MODERATE
Walks after meals lower blood sugar	MODERATE	Walking boosts creative thinking	MODERATE

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